

5 PREPOSITIONS

A preposition is a word that connects a noun or pronoun to other words in a sentence. Prepositions help us know the **place**, **time**, and **direction** of things in a sentence.

Prepositions of Place (Where something is)

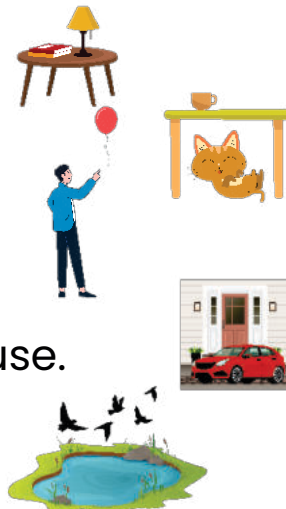
☞ The book is on the table.

☞ The cat is hiding under the table.

☞ The balloon is above my head.

☞ The car is parked in front of the house.

☞ The birds are flying over the lake.



Prepositions of Time (When something happens)

☞ I have breakfast before school.

☞ We go to the playground after lunch.

☞ My birthday is in October.

☞ I sleep at 9 o'clock.

☞ We pray during the evening.



Prepositions of Direction (Where something is going)

☞ She walked to the market.

☞ The kite flew towards the sky.

☞ He ran into the classroom.

☞ The ball rolled across the floor.

☞ We drove from Karachi to Lahore.



The table shows uses of '**in**,' '**on**,' and '**at**' with examples for both place and time:

In

Use	Place	Time
Enclosed Spaces.	The cat is in the box.	He wakes up in the morning.
Countries, cities, regions.	She lives in Karachi.	We moved here in 2020.
Large areas (neighbourhoods, parks).	There are ducks in the park.	It gets cold in winter.
Months, years, decades.		The event is in March.
Parts of the day.		We study in the afternoon.

On

Use	Place	Time
Surfaces.	The pen is on the desk.	
Specific days and dates.		The meeting is on Wednesday.
Streets, roads.	Our house is on Tariq road.	
Transportation (buses, trains).	She is on the bus.	
Technology (TV, phone, internet.)	He is watching a show on TV.	

At

Use	Place	Time
Specific points or locations.	She is waiting at the entrance	
Addresses.	He lives at lane 2, DHA.	
Events.	They are at a concert.	
Specific times.		The class starts at 9:00 am.
Expressions (e.g., at night, at noon)		We eat lunch at noon.

5.1

Circle the correct preposition of place.

-  There's some milk **in / at** the fridge.
-  He works **at / on** the new university.
-  It was very dark **in / on** the forest.
-  They live **on / in** Brazil.
-  Don't put your bag **on / at** the ground! It's wet!
-  Sofia's **on / at** school.
-  Are you **in / on** this photo?
-  I'll see you **in / at** the bus stop at eight o'clock.
-  Let's sit **on / at** the grass.
-  Room 3 is **at / on** the top of the building.
-  There's a big tree **behind / below / between** the school.
-  We live on the second floor. Mr. Ali lives **next to / above / below** us, on the first floor.
-  I stood **near / below / opposite** the fire and it was hot.
-  Stand **behind / between / in front of** the tower. I'll take a photo of you.
-  Can I sit **opposite / next to / behind** you at the cinema?
-  Someone's coming! Quick! Hide **behind / under / above** that wall!

5.2

Write about your bedroom and your classroom.
Answer the questions.

My bedroom

-  Where is your bedroom in your house or flat?
-  What's above and below it?
-  Do you have these things in your bedroom? If so, where are they?

a clock posters photos a lamp books
shelves a wardrobe a chair clothes
shoes a rug a mirror a table
a radiator or air-conditioning unit

MY BEDROOM

My bedroom is at the top of the house. Our kitchen
is below it. The neighbour's kitchen is above it. My
bed is next to the window and there is...

5.3

Circle the correct preposition of time.

-  See you **in / on** Wednesday!
-  He was born **in / at** 1972.
-  The film starts **at / on** six o'clock.
-  Bats and foxes don't sleep **in / at** night.
-  My birthday is **in / at** the spring.
-  We play tennis **at / on** Fridays.
-  I always do my homework **in / on** the morning.
-  There's a music festival **in / on** 2nd May.

5.4

Write the words in the correct place.

~~four o'clock~~ October the evening Mondays
 the weekend 19th January night the winter
 Friday morning half past six 2006
 his birthday break-time

in

on

at

four o'clock

5.5

Complete the conversations with in, on, or at.

 When did you start school?

in 2006.

 When do you do sport?

_____ Mondays, Thursdays, and Fridays.

 Is your birthday _____ the autumn?

No, it's _____ the spring.

 When does this lesson finish?

_____ quarter to three.

 When do you brush your teeth?

_____ the morning and _____ bedtime.

 When will you next see your grandparents and cousins?

_____ my birthday.

 What do you have for breakfast _____ school days?

Cereal and milk.